

Introduction to Biblical Greek

Session 1

Course Goals

- To be able to read and write Biblical Greek.
- Memorize 100 core vocabulary words.
- Understand basic Greek grammar.
- Learn tools to engage in exegesis.

Course Outline

1. Ten sessions.
2. Four exams:
 - 12 May: Exam 1 / 30 minutes.
 - 26 May: Exam 2 / 30 minutes.
 - 9 June: Exam 3 / 30 minutes.
 - 23 June: *Revision class* (23 June)
 - 30 June: Final exam / 1.5 hours.

Course Exams

Prepare:

1. Blank A4 sheets + stationery.
2. A smartphone or device to scan the answer sheets.
3. A laptop with webcam.

Why learn Biblical Greek?

“The only people I have heard say that Greek is not important are those who do not themselves know Greek. Strange. Can you imagine someone who knows nothing about tennis saying that it is unnecessary ever to take tennis lessons? Sounds ridiculous, doesn’t it?”

William Mounce, *Basics of Biblical Greek* (Grand Rapids: Zondervan, 2009)

Why learn Biblical Greek?

“Do you inquire what use there is in learning the languages? Do you say, 'We can read the Bible very well in German?' Without the languages we could not have received the Gospel. Languages are the scabbard that contains the sword of the Spirit; they are the casket which contains the priceless jewels of antique thought; they are the vessel that holds the wine.”

Martin Luther

Why learn Biblical Greek?

“Led by the Holy Spirit, but accompanied by humanist studies, one should proceed to theology... but since the Bible is written in part in Hebrew and in part in Greek—as Latinists we drink from the stream of both—we must learn these languages, unless we want to be “silent persons.””

Philipp Melanchthon

Why learn Biblical Greek?

“A little bit of Greek can be very dangerous.”

Lim Kar Yong

“A little bit of Greek goes a long way.”

Also, Lim Kar Yong

Key Terms (Writing)

- Transliteration:
The English alphabet phonetic of the Greek.
- Gloss definition:
The basic meaning of a word.

3rd, 3rd

αγαπᾶω
agapao

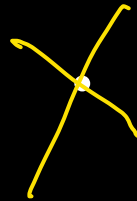
talked
||
to speak, past tense



Key Terms (Writing)

- Breathing marks:

Comma-like marks above vowels of words beginning with a vowel.

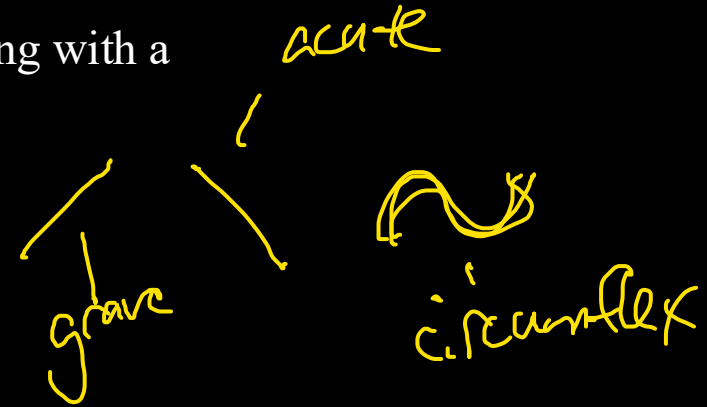


- Accents (*not assessed*):

Diacritical marks above certain letters of a word.

- The *iota* subscript:

An *iota* written below a vowel of certain nouns.



Key Terms (Grammar)

We = I
you = you
they = he/she

provide all grammar info
person, number, tense.

- To parse:
~~To write the English alphabet phonetic of the Greek.~~
- To decline:
To 'modify' the ending of Greek nouns to reflect subject, object, etc.
- To conjugate:
To 'modify' Greek verbs to reflect person, number, tense, etc.

par = ban
run

Erasmian = β b

Key Terms (Pronunciation)

- Diphthongs:**

Combination of two vowels.

oi ~~au~~ au

Byzantine

- Breathing Marks:**

' = unmodified.

◊

= adds an 'h' sound before the vowel. E.g., ◊ is pronounced 'ho'.

the
C
◊ = ho

- The gamma nasal**

When a *gamma* is followed by another velar (κ, γ, χ, or ξ).

αγγελος
angelos

ng

~~gg~~

Break

Try writing your own name in Greek!

9:15 pm

John 3:16

οὕτως γὰρ ἠγάπησεν ὁ θεὸς τὸν κόσμον

ὥστε τὸν υἱὸν τὸν μονογενῆ ἔδωκεν

ἵνα πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων εἰς αὐτὸν

μὴ ἀπόληται ἀλλ' ἔχῃ ζωὴν αἰώνιον

iota subscript.